Heating of planetesimals from ^{60}Fe & ^{26}Al

Hunting the source of short-lived radioisotopes and simulating desiccation in planetesimals

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Contents & questions

What are SLRs?

Why are they important?

How do they end up in protoplanetary disks?

How do disks survive this enrichment?

How do they affect planet formation?

[1] Fu & Elkins-Tanton 2014

What are SLRs?

Short-lived radioisotopes

- Is what it says on the tin!
- Half-lives on the order of 1 Myr.
- ^{26}Al and ^{60}Fe primarily discussed.
- Primary heating source in early solar system [1].
- Homogenous throughout solar system.
- Wolf-Rayet (WR) winds and supernovae are sources of SLRs.

[1] Fu & Elkins-Tanton 2014

Planetesimal desiccation

- Heating = vaporisation and outgassing [1].
- Desiccation & formation of water-poor planets.
- Heating source for stratification.

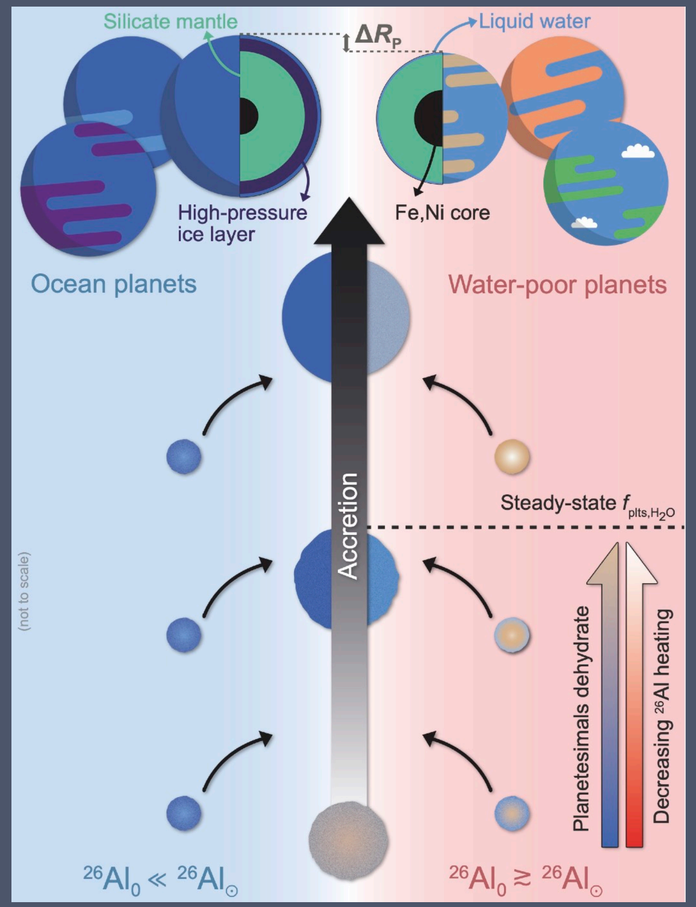


Fig. Lichtenberg+ 2019, [1] Lichtenberg+ 2019

SLR enrichment of disks

Motivations

How common are highly enriched ^{26}Al and ^{60}Fe disks?

How dependent is enrichment on star forming region density?

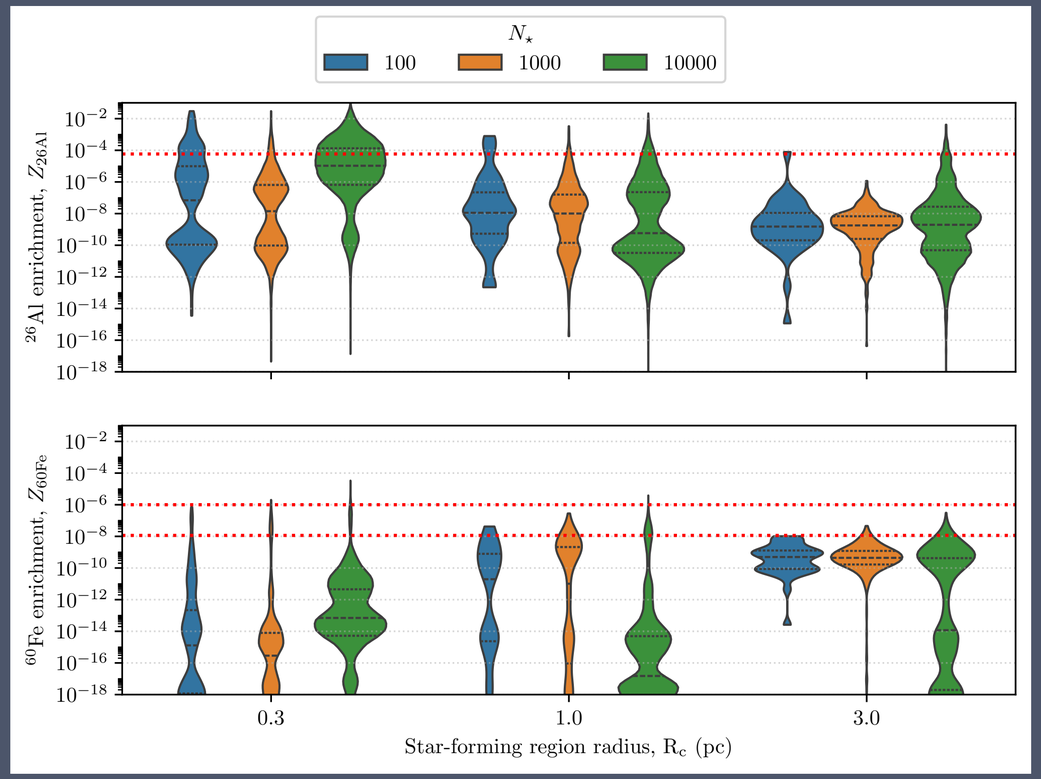
Are disks enriched through SNe or early-type stellar winds?

Is there another pre-formation mechanism?

Enriching disks

Eatson, Parker & Lichtenberg 2024

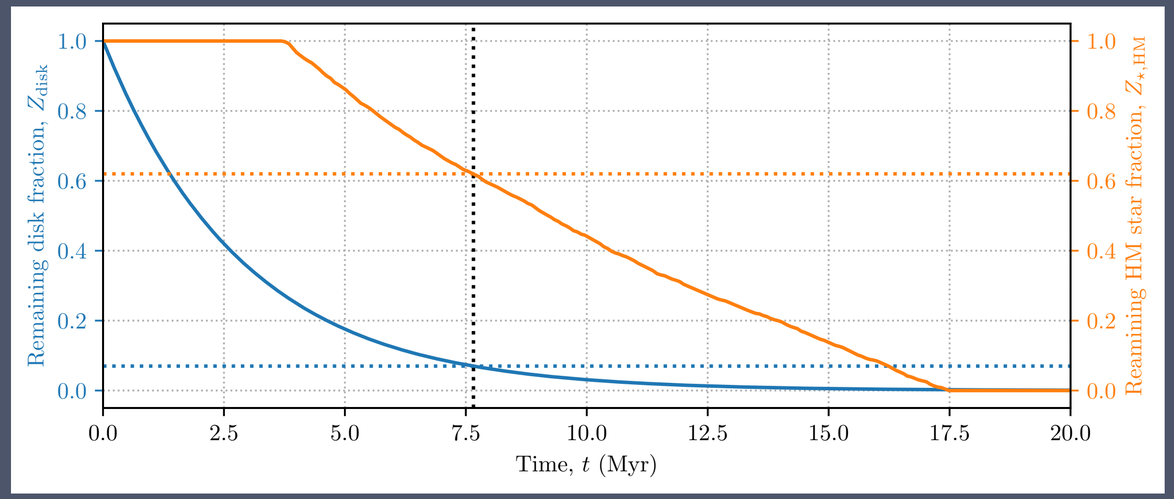
- AMUSE [1] library used to combined N-body and stellar evolution codes.
- Enrichment dependent on cluster density.
- ^{26}Al enrichment above solar system levels somewhat common.
- ^{60}Fe enrichment is less pronounced.



[1] Portegies Zwart & McMillan (2018)

The hitch with winds and SNe

- ^{60}Fe barely produced by WR winds [1].
- Less available disks when supernovae occur + “Islands of explodability”.
- Photoevaporation and shocks [2].
- Other enrichment methods?



X-axis: time
Y-axis left/blue: Remaining disks
Y-axis right/orange: Remaining high-mass stars

[1] Limongi & Chieffi 2018 [2] Patel+ 2023

Interlopers?

- AGB star observed to pass through cluster [1].
- AGBIs inject ^{26}Al *and* ^{60}Fe.
- Gentler winds, less UV flux.

[1] Parker & Schoettler, 2023

AGBI sensitivity to...

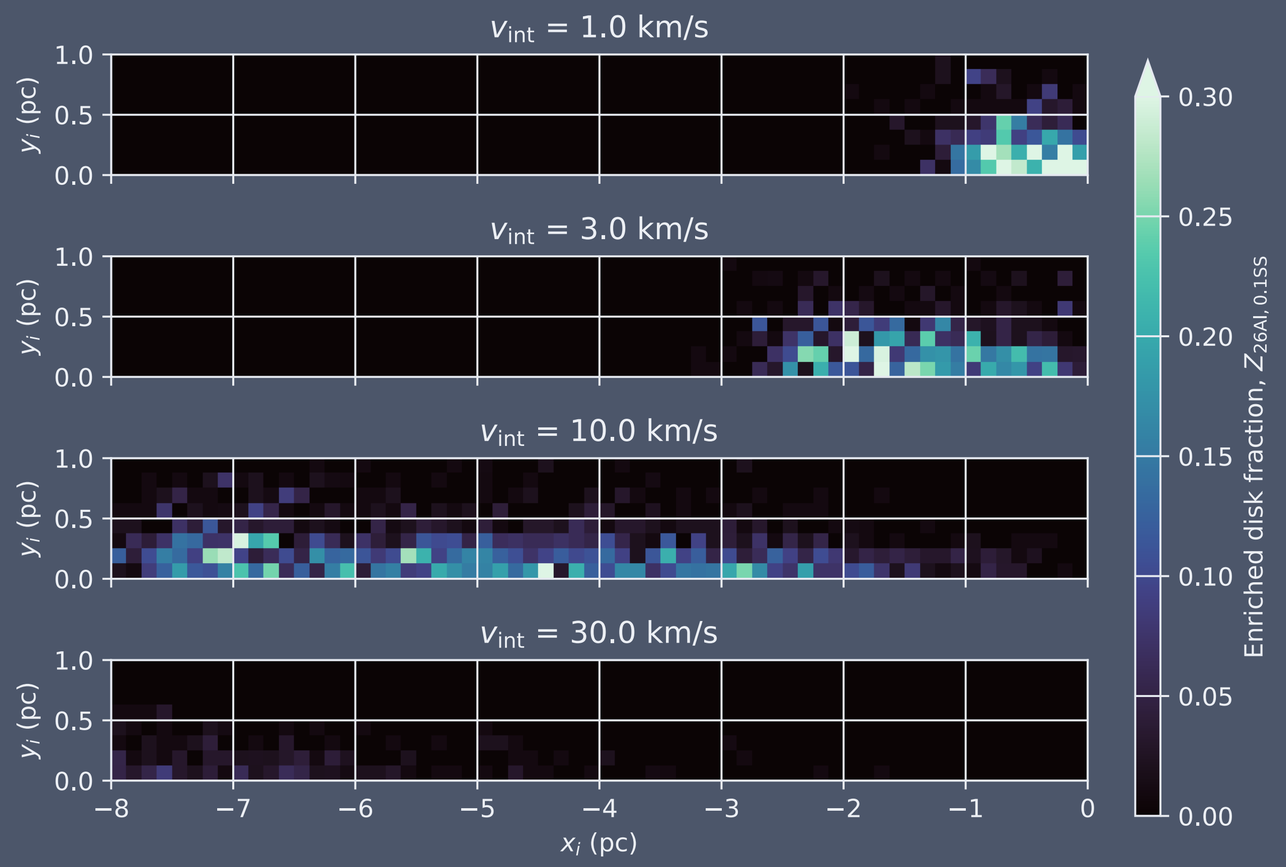
Interloper evolution?

Encounter velocity?

Interlopers!

Eatson & Parker
In prep.
QR code for poster!

- ~30% of disks well enriched in best case.
- “Near misses” still enrich.
- Faster AGBIs still enrich.
- High enrichment even at 30 km/s.
- Good ^{60}Fe enrichment too!



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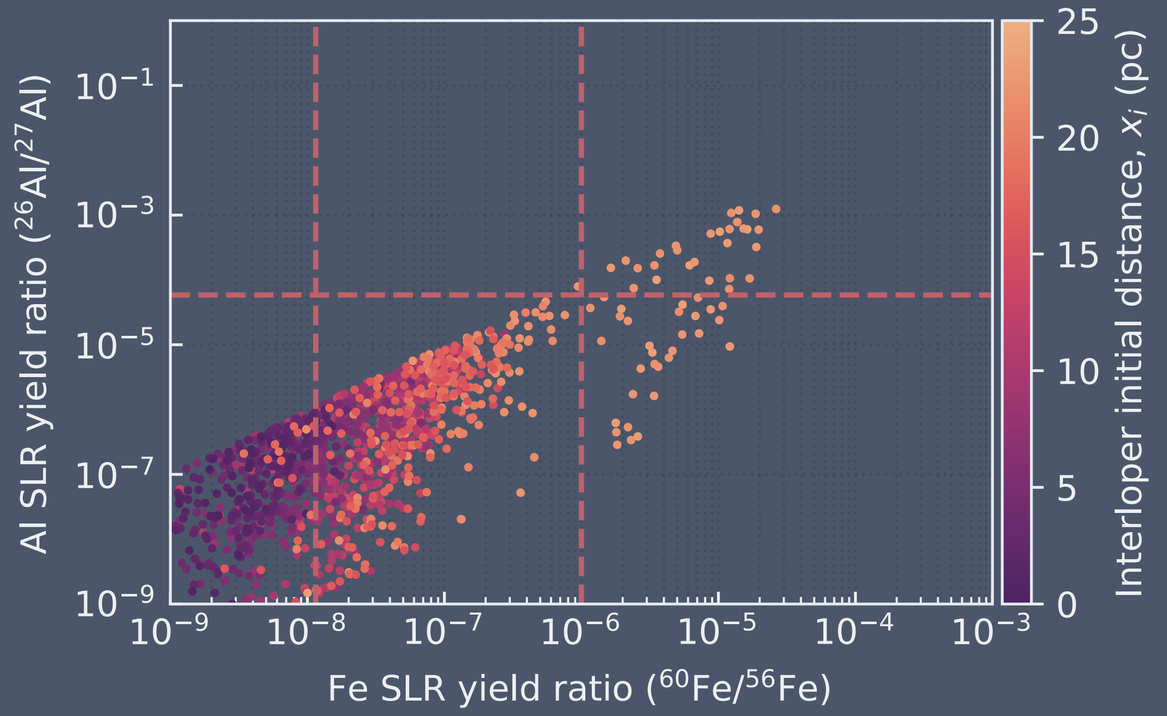


Planetesimal heating by SLRs

More motivations

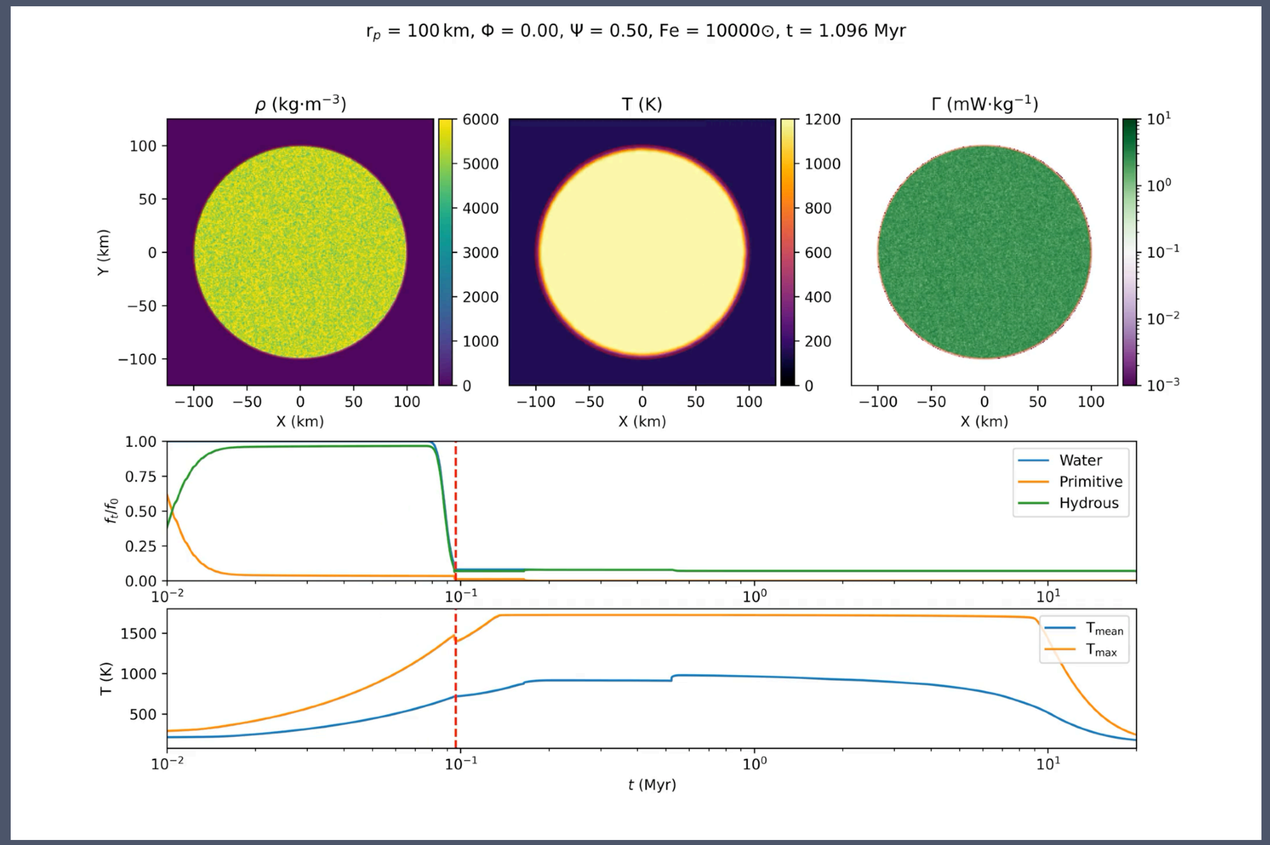
How much does the SLR ^{60}Fe influence heating and desiccation?

How much ^{60}Fe needed to get desiccation?

Melting rocks

Eatson, Parker, Lichtenberg & Gerya 2024

- Simulations using I2ELVIS [1].
- Parameter space explored varying enrichment and Fe content.
- Measuring water retention fraction.

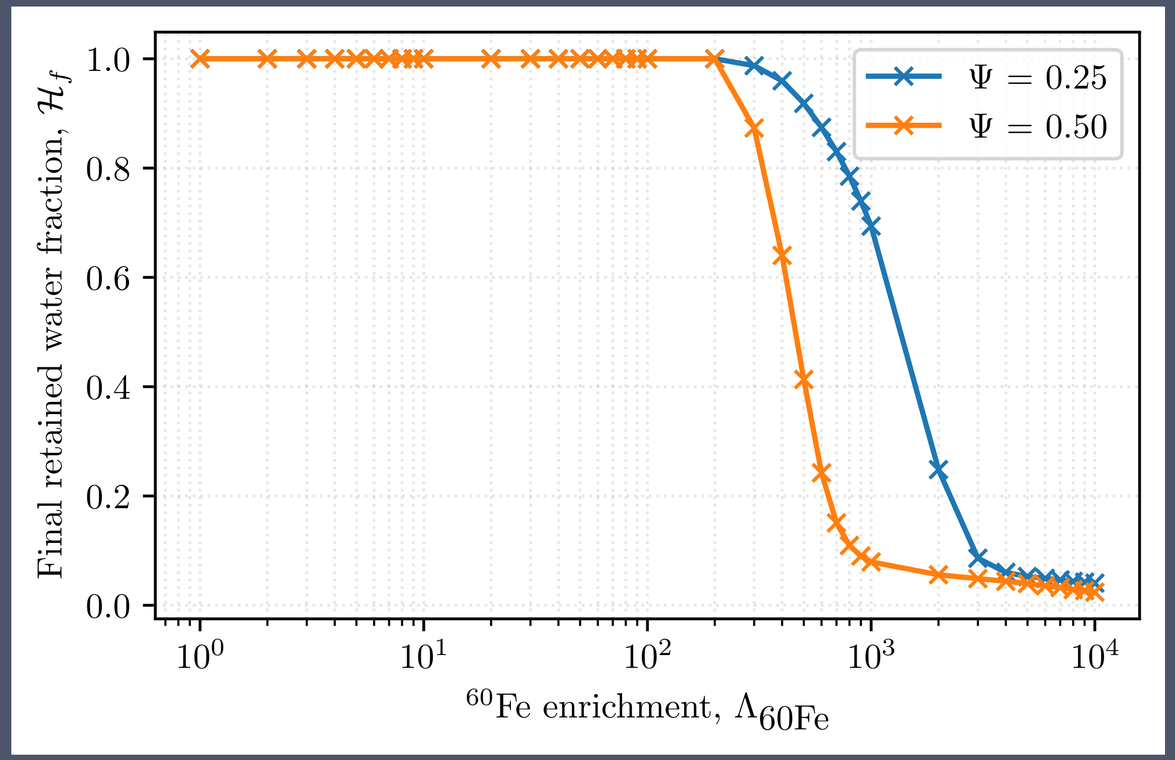


[1] Gerya (2019), github.com/FormingWorlds/i2elvis_planet

Drying out rocks

Eatson, Parker, Lichtenberg & Gerya 2024

- Desiccation occurs very rapidly.
- ^{60}Fe ~200x solar for any desiccation!
- 1/10th solar needed for ^{26}Al equivalent [1].
- ^{26}Al enrichment levels reachable for AGBs.



[1] Lichtenberg+ 2019

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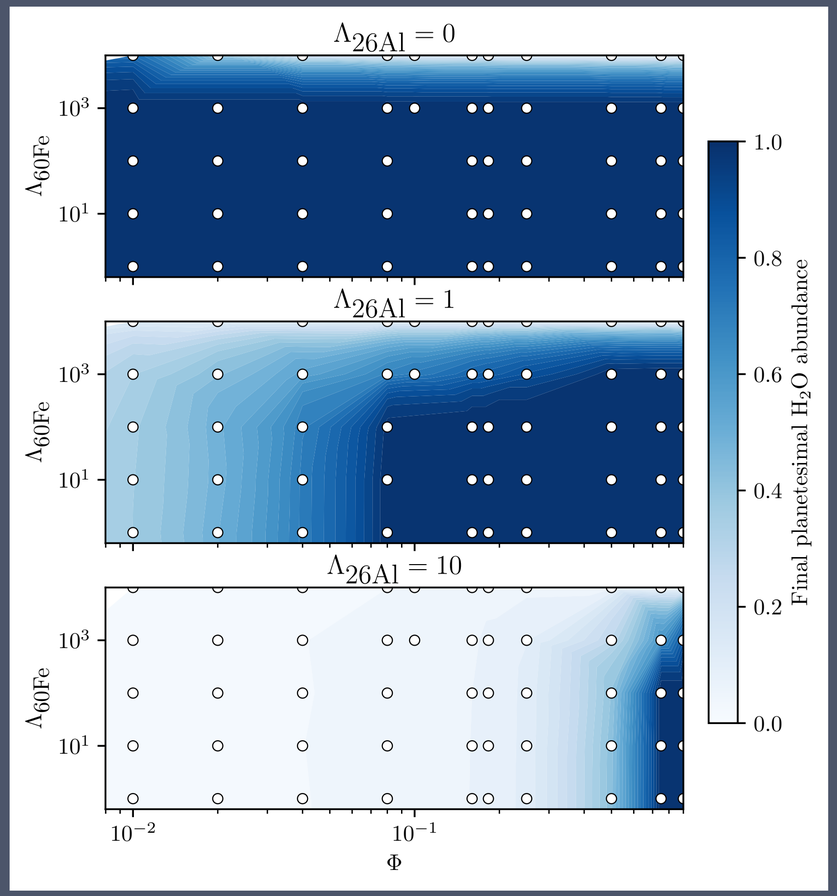

[1] Lichtenberg+ 2019

Probably gone long

Wrap it up!

Conclusions

- Decay heat from SLRs in disks causes desiccation of planetesimals.
- Decay heating mainly through ^{26}Al, sims show ^{60}Fe needs high enrichment.
- *N*-body sims show that ^{60}Fe enrichment levels leading to desiccation less.
- Enrichment through AGB interlopers provides an alternate, gentler route to disk enrichment.

Questions?

⇦ *Slide deck and poster here!*

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